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letter

etter:

I was writing this to keep busy(especially my fingers), to share with therapist, and to share with you.(Sue)
Hopefully the following will provide some answers about who I am, because, well I am complicated.

psychology stuff

Autodidact polymath with hyperphantasia, F41.1 anxiety and dysthymia.

A highly complex, deeply interconnected ecosystem where exceptional cognitive strengths directly interact with vulnerable emotional states.

You possess a rare and powerful intellectual toolkit, but your hyper-vivid imagination and relentless self-directed mind can also become engines for chronic distress if left unmanaged.

The intersection of strengths and vulnerabilities:

[Autodidact Polymath] —> Needs constant mental stimulation

[Hyperphantasia] —————> Photorealistic mental processing
(Can create cinematic worries/rumination)

[F41.1 (GAD) & Dysthymia] —> Low-grade, chronic gloom fueling
high-alert threat detection

The Hyperphantasia Amplification:

Hyperphantasia grants you an exceptionally vivid, photorealistic "mind's eye."

While this allows you to map out complex, multi-disciplinary systems or conceptualize vast ideas effortlessly, it has a steep dark side when

paired with anxiety. When your F41.1 generalized anxiety kicks in, your brain doesn't just think about a worst-case scenario; it generates a cinematic, sensory-rich masterpiece of that failure.

The Dysthymic Baseline:

Dysthymia (persistent depressive disorder) acts like a heavy, low-grade fog. It lowers your emotional baseline, causing chronic fatigue and a lack of momentum.

For an autodidact polymath who relies on internal drive to pursue new subjects, dysthymia creates a painful friction: your intellect is starving for stimulation, but your brain chemistry denies you the energy or sense of reward needed to pursue it.

The "Analysis Paralysis" Loop:

Polymathic minds naturally see connections everywhere. When F41.1 anxiety hijacks this trait, it manifests as Repetitive Negative Thinking (RNT).

Your brain uses its vast knowledge base to cross-reference threats, building an overwhelming web of "what-ifs" that can paralyze your ability to start or finish projects.

2000

The Chris Becker / Alex Lindsay nepotism thing. Back around '99-2000, I was pretty much at maximum burnout. Throughout the 90's I was bouncing around aimlessly from various temp jobs and a few decent security jobs. I didn't actually graduate in '90 because we moved and I went from North middle school straight into Smoky Hill High (Cherry Creek district), then back to Aurora Central High in '88. The difference between them was pretty extreme and I was working full time at King Soopers the entire time. Also a bunch of bad decisions on my part and the crowd I fell in with at Central. They did keep me on the roster after dropping out so Pickens Tech would remain free into '91.

Around 2000 I met Chris Becker through Dad's friend Phread Duncan and was usually helping him with computer stuff and we became friends. I introduced him to all the fun and cool stuff that can be done with them such as Photoshop and 3D graphics, etc. During that time he had a girlfriend, Courtney, whom I thought was pretty young. He would even say things to Dad and I like "I like the younger types because freshness". He was also a 'rich kid' silver spoon. In 2001 his Dad remarried and all the sudden in October 2001 he's off to an internship out in San Francisco called DV Garage under Alex Lindsay. He was handed everything.

Right before he left I asked him how all this came to be and he said that "Alex owed his family a favor".

I think he said something along the lines of him getting things in order first, then having me come out. That never happened and around 2003 I went back to work doing part-time security graveyard shifts. He called the house later and was telling Dad all about his interview with ILM (Industrial Light and Magic). That's my dream job!

One really bad night, I ran out of gas going to work at the Qwest building downtown and didn't have my phone on me nor any phone

numbers to call in to let someone know. I did manage to get to a 7-11 and called home to have someone bring out the gas can but by the time Mom made it out it was several hours later. I kind of lost my shit in the parking lot of that 7-11 that night and a few days later I enrolled into Aurora Mental Health. After just a couple appointments they put me on Paxil, then Zoloft. From 2003 to just before

2005. Almost two years and Mom was paying out of pocket. I pretty much shut down then.

Those meds have since been deemed as possibly dangerous, especially if suddenly stopped.

I did talk to Jeff about it at the time - "Sigh, fucking nepotism".

Chris used to be on Facebook and Courtney's profile used to have her b-day - 1985. Currently, he seems to have vanished and her profile no longer has her b-day shown. I wonder if someone said something? I wonder if it caught up to him?

Childhood

My childhood was actually freaking' AMAZING! Good friends such as Chad Hayashi and a few others. I was also surrounded by Dad's friends such as Mike Flannagan, Clark Bar, Larry Webb, and Phread Duncan. It was full of intellectuals, art, music and musicians, wonder, curiosity,

excitement, fun, and so, so much love! We have several photo albums full of pictures of all that.

Mike lived on Kingston st and we spent a lot of time in his den. He was into the fine arts and good music. Larry was the photographer and a family man with his wife Jen Webb and two kids, Lara and I forget their son's name. Clark was actually Dad's best friend who was an aspiring actor and incredibly intelligent. He did have one small part in the pilot for 'How the West Was Won' TV series. Phread was the wise wizard hippie.

My childhood was also not without trauma. Of course preschool and also I forget what year, I was sitting in the living room playing or whatever and Dad just got out of the shower and was sitting there reading the newspaper. All the sudden he started violently convulsing, Mom was screaming "Dave, DAVE!" as she tried holding him down and yelling at me to go outside. Grandma was also frantic and on the phone to 911. What happened was his upper sinus ruptured and exploded into his brain. They basically scalped him, folded the flap over and drilled in to drain and relieve pressure.











Grandmother

My grandmother on Dad's side actually raised two kids by herself. Dad and my Aunt Sherry. Originally from Iowa, her brother drowned when they were kids and later her husband left her. Didn't want the commitment, so he just up and left them. When Dad was young he would get bad bronchitis from Iowa's humidity, so they moved to Aurora for the dry climate. 1704 Kenton st., then to S. Ouray Ct with all of us, then into this current house in '88.

A year after she retired with two federal pensions (20 years in the Navy and 20 years at the FAA building that used to be on 26th Ave), she had a severe stroke that left her half paralyzed with very little vocabulary.

For the first year after, around '89, Mom was taking care of her. Later she needed more help than what they could do here at home so they tried a couple nursing homes here in Aurora, then finally a home in Rifle. The pensions evaporated. She hung in there for ten years.

This nice house in Park East is what she worked so hard for, for all of us.



Financial

To quote the movie Full Metal Jacket - "I'm in a world of fuck" No income since 2003. No bank accounts or 'plastic numbers' whatsoever. I recently checked my credit and it's now 'unscorable' because somewhere along the line it got mixed up with Dad's. It was 768 prior to his death.

...family fight....

What happened here about a month ago was once again there was more screaming from next door and I was getting triggered and grumpy. Mom and sis are actually more upset at that than all the bullshit next door. My sister came upstairs screaming at me about not working and how she's working at a job she hates and all the financial burdens she's carrying. The BBB thing came up and I tried to remind them that he was lying. She had absolutely no interest in observing the proof. Mom started going on about not knowing what to tell her family about what I'm doing for a living. It all got turned around into one giant gaslight with me being the problem. Things are ok in here now. My family is very resilient and my sudden skyrocketing blood pressure probably had something to do with it.

....was upset...

Yes, I was upset with you a few weeks ago. I felt like I was lied to and deceived.

...me stuff...

It feels like I'm being pinched while the rug is being pulled out from under me and I'm totally overloaded. Also feeling drained and diminished.

Watching other people just leave while I remain stuck here hurts like hell!

I need out, but don't have a way out.